User Personas

Understanding how different people experience ClickUp as a project management tool

Domain: Project Management SaaS — ClickUp

01

USER PERSONA

Priya Nair



AGE 29

EDUCATION MBA, Marketing

HOMETOWN Pune

FAMILY Single, lives with roommates

OCCUPATION Operations Lead, 12-person marketing agency

> **“I just want my team on one system — I didn't sign up to become a ClickUp admin.”**

Story / Scenario

Priya moved her agency o
spent her first week confi
redo the structure after h

Problem Statement

Priya is a non-technical te

RESEARCH BACKING

Feature overwhelm is the single most common complaint in ClickUp reviews — many teams report a 2-4 week onboarding period before feeling productive, and Capterra reviewers describe the learning curve as "incredibly steep" with an interface that "can feel very overwhelming and cluttered when you are first setting things up."

ClickUp Alternatives | The Business Dive

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Priya is a non-technical team lead at a small agency who needs a fast, guided way to set up ClickUp for her whole team, because the current setup process assumes a level of configuration knowledge she doesn't have.

GOALS

- Get the whole team working out of one shared system within a week
- Keep client work organized without adding overhead to her own job

FRUSTRATIONS

- Faced with Workspace/Space/Folder/List/Task all at once with no guided path
- Built the wrong hierarchy twice before getting it usable
- Team consistently struggles to find tasks once the system is set up

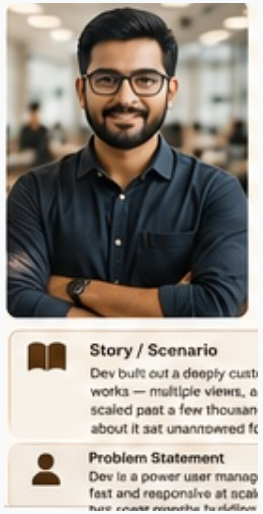
BRIEF STORY / SCENARIO

Priya moved her agency off spreadsheets expecting ClickUp to be a quick swap. Instead she spent her first week configuring Spaces and Lists instead of running client projects, and had to redo the structure after her team got lost trying to find their own tasks.

02

USER PERSONA

Dev Kulkarni



AGE	34
EDUCATION	B.Tech, Computer Science
HOMETOWN	Bengaluru
FAMILY	Married
OCCUPATION	Senior Project Manager, 200-person digital agency

> **“I built the perfect system for my team — I just wish it didn't lag every time I open it.”**

RESEARCH BACKING

"Slow Loading" is tagged in 1,154 G2 reviews, and users continue to report navigation lag and delayed status updates in larger workspaces even after ClickUp's 3.0 performance rewrite. One reviewer's top complaint list includes "platform is slow (pages take up to 5 seconds to load)" alongside a buggy UI.

Capterra

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Dev is a power user managing a large, complex, multi-client workload who needs ClickUp to stay fast and responsive at scale, because performance degradation directly threatens the workflow he's spent months building.

GOALS

- Run 15+ concurrent client projects with custom statuses, dependencies, and dashboards
- Keep full visibility across every client without switching tools

FRUSTRATIONS

- Workspace has grown to thousands of tasks and now visibly lags
- Support tickets about performance take days to get a real answer
- Feels like he's fighting the tool's limits instead of his own workflow

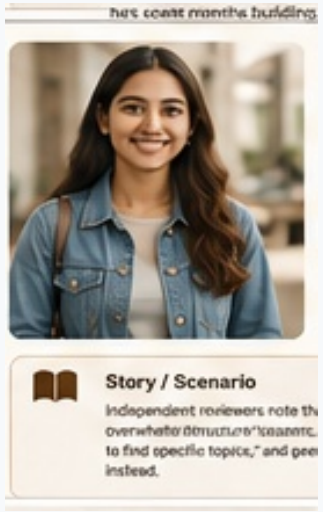
BRIEF STORY / SCENARIO

Dev built out a deeply customized ClickUp system that finally matched how his agency actually works — multiple views, automations, dependencies across clients. But as the workspace scaled past a few thousand tasks, pages started taking seconds to load, and a support ticket about it sat unanswered for most of a week.

03

USER PERSONA

Aditi Sharma



AGE	20
EDUCATION	Final-year B.E., Computer Engineering
HOMETOWN	Mumbai
FAMILY	Lives at home with parents
OCCUPATION	Student (also applying for internships)

> **“I wanted a to-do list. I got a project management degree instead.”**

RESEARCH BACKING

Independent reviewers note that the amount of content and structure "can sometimes be overwhelming for new users, making it difficult to find specific topics," and even G2's own data shows ease of setup satisfaction (85%) trailing ease of use (88%) — the gap where students like Aditi tend to fall off.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Aditi is a student with no organizational training or budget who needs an immediately usable task system for personal and group work, because she has neither the time nor the incentive to push through a steep setup process the way a paid team might.

GOALS

- Track coursework deadlines, a 4-person capstone project, and internship applications in one free tool
- Get set up in minutes with zero training or onboarding support

FRUSTRATIONS

- Expected something like a checklist app, instead landed on a multi-level setup screen
- No one to train her — if the first 10 minutes don't work, she'll abandon it
- Free plan's view limits nudge her toward paid tiers she can't justify for personal use

BRIEF STORY / SCENARIO

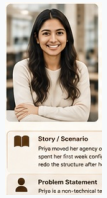
Aditi downloaded ClickUp after a classmate recommended it for their capstone group. She hit the Workspace/Space/Folder setup flow, got confused about where her actual tasks were supposed to go, and gave up halfway — going back to a shared Google Doc checklist instead.

User Journey Maps

Mapping each persona's path from first click to daily use.

Domain: Project Management SaaS — ClickUp

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USER JOURNEY MAP

Priya's Journey to Roll Out ClickUp Across Her Team

PERSONA Priya Nair **GOAL** Get her 12-person agency running on ClickUp within a week, without becoming a full-time admin.

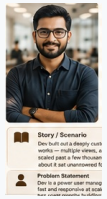
> **"I just want my team on one system — I didn't sign up to become a ClickUp admin."**

ACTION	1. DISCOVER & SIGN UP	2. INITIAL SETUP	3. FIRST ROLLOUT	4. REBUILD & ADJUST	5. DAILY USE	6. STEADY STATE
	Looking for a spreadsheet replacement	Structuring the workspace alone	Introducing the tool to the team	Fixing the workspace based on feedback	Running real client work through ClickUp	ClickUp becomes the daily driver
TASK LIST	• Searches for a project management tool for small agencies • Signs up for the free trial • Adds two teammates to test it	• Meets the Workspace/Space/Folder/List hierarchy with no guidance • Guesses at a structure based on client names • Spends most of day one configuring, not using	• Walks teammates through the structure she built • Team can't find their own tasks • Realizes the hierarchy needs a rebuild	• Rebuilds Spaces and Folders around team feedback • Watches a few tutorial videos to speed things up • Slowly gets buy-in as things click	• Uses task lists and due dates for daily deliverables • Occasionally still loses track of where something lives • Team has mostly adapted	• Reviews workload across the team weekly • Onboards new hires with her documented structure • Recommends the setup to other teams
FEELING ADJECTIVE	**Hopeful** *Excited to finally get everyone off scattered spreadsheets.*	**Overwhelmed** *Too many setup decisions before doing any real work.*	**Frustrated** *The structure that made sense to her didn't make sense to anyone else.*	**Cautiously hopeful** *Progress, but it's taken far longer than planned.*	**Relieved** *It finally works, even if onboarding took longer than expected.*	**Confident** *The system finally runs itself.*
IMPROVEMENT OPPORTUNITIES	• Simple starter template for small teams • Clearer first-run walkthrough	• Guided setup wizard • Sensible defaults for agencies	• Team-view templates that mirror how staff think • In-app onboarding for invited members	• Built-in short video tips per feature • Undo-friendly restructuring tools	• Smarter global search • Weekly digest of what moved where	• Shareable workspace templates for other teams

OVERALL EXPERIENCE With a guided setup wizard and clearer defaults for small teams, Priya's onboarding could take days instead of weeks — turning early frustration into confidence much sooner.

★★★◐☆

02



USER JOURNEY MAP

Dev's Journey Scaling ClickUp Across 15+ Client Projects

PERSONA Dev Kulkarni **GOAL** Keep a complex, multi-client workflow fast and reliable as it scales.

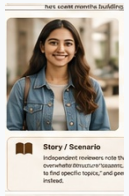
> **"I built the perfect system for my team — I just wish it didn't lag every time I open it."**

ACTION	1. BUILD THE SYSTEM	2. SCALE UP	3. HIT THE LAG	4. SEEK SUPPORT	5. WORK AROUND IT	6. LONG-TERM TRADE-OFF
	Designing a custom workflow	Adding more projects and automations	Performance starts to degrade	Raising a ticket about the slowdown	Adjusting habits to cope	Weighing whether to keep scaling here
TASK LIST	• Sets up dedicated Spaces per client • Builds custom statuses and dependencies • Configures dashboards for weekly reviews	• Adds more clients and recurring automations • Connects dependencies across projects • Workspace grows past a few thousand tasks	• Notices pages taking seconds to load • Sees delayed status updates across views • Work slows down across the whole team	• Opens a support ticket describing the lag • Waits several days for a substantive reply • Shares workarounds with his team in the meantime	• Archives old completed projects to lighten the workspace • Splits large views into smaller ones • Trains the team to avoid the heaviest dashboards	• Compares notes with peers on other tools • Weighs migration cost against staying • Decides to stay, but stays cautious about growth
FEELING ADJECTIVE	**Confident** *Finally has a system that matches how the agency works.*	**Productive** *The system is paying off as it grows.*	**Frustrated** *The tool starts working against him instead of for him.*	**Impatient** *Needs an answer faster than support can give one.*	**Resigned** *Manages around the limitation rather than solving it.*	**Uncertain** *Committed for now, but not fully confident it will hold at greater scale.*
IMPROVEMENT OPPORTUNITIES	• Workflow templates for agencies at scale	• Usage insights before performance degrades	• Better performance at high task volume • In-app performance status indicator	• Faster response tiers for paid plans • Public status page for known performance issues	• Auto-archiving suggestions • Lighter-weight view options for large workspaces	• A clear scaling roadmap so power users can plan ahead

OVERALL EXPERIENCE If performance held steady past a few thousand tasks, Dev's workflow would scale as well as his ambitions — right now, the tool's limits cap how far he's willing to grow inside it.

★★★◐☆

03



USER JOURNEY MAP

Aditi's Journey Trying to Use ClickUp for Coursework

PERSONA Aditi Sharma **GOAL** Get an immediately usable, free task setup for coursework and a group project.

> **"I wanted a to-do list. I got a project management degree instead."**

ACTION	1. DISCOVER	2. FIRST OPEN	3. ATTEMPT SETUP	4. HIT A WALL	5. ABANDON OR PUSH THROUGH	6. FALLBACK
	A classmate recommends ClickUp	Faced with workspace setup screens	Trying to create a simple task list	Free plan limits and options pile up	A decision point	Returns to a simpler tool
TASK LIST	• Hears about ClickUp from a capstone teammate • Downloads the app expecting a checklist tool • Creates a free account	• Lands on Workspace/Space/Folder setup • Isn't sure which option fits a small student project • Skips several setup steps without understanding them	• Creates a List for the capstone project • Tries to add teammates and assign tasks • Struggles to find where due dates and views live	• Runs into free-plan view limits • Gets prompted to upgrade for features she doesn't understand • Loses track of which settings she's already tried	• Weighs sticking with ClickUp against switching back • Asks her teammate for help, who is equally unsure • Decides it isn't worth the time for a single project	• Goes back to a shared Google Doc checklist • Uses WhatsApp for team coordination instead • Keeps ClickUp installed but unused
FEELING ADJECTIVE	**Curious** *Open to trying it, no strong expectations either way.*	**Confused** *Expected to start typing tasks, not configuring a system.*	**Determined** *Still willing to figure it out for the group project.*	**Overwhelmed** *The tool is asking more of her than the assignment does.*	**Defeated** *Ten minutes in, this already feels like more effort than it's worth.*	**Resigned** *Reverts to what already worked, without hard feelings toward the tool.*
IMPROVEMENT OPPORTUNITIES	• Clear framing of ClickUp as more than a to-do app upfront	• A lightweight 'personal/student' mode at signup	• Simpler task-creation flow with fewer decisions upfront	• Clearer free-vs-paid boundaries before hitting a wall • Fewer upgrade prompts during first-time setup	• A visible 'quick win' early in setup to build confidence	• Lightweight template built specifically for student group projects

OVERALL EXPERIENCE A simplified, guided path for personal or small-group use — with fewer upfront decisions — could keep students like Aditi from bouncing off ClickUp in the first ten minutes. ★★◐☆☆